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Section Title(S)

Category 1: ego's consanguineous relatives with whom marriage is forbidden • Category 2: affines

FIG. 2. *Consanguineous relatives whom ego must not marry*

	Male	Female	Joking
Great-grandparents . . .	<i>tsu</i>	<i>llga</i>	no
Grandparents . . .	<i>!gu!na</i>	<i>tün</i>	yes
Parents . . .	<i>ba</i>	<i>dai</i>	} no
Siblings of parents . . .	<i>tsu</i>	<i>llga</i>	
Siblings . . .	<i>!go</i>	<i>!kwi</i>	{ yes, same sex no, opp. sex
Cousins, 1st, 2nd, 3rd . . .	<i>!gu!na</i>	<i>tün</i>	yes
Offspring . . .	<i>!ha</i>	<i>≠ khai</i>	} no
Nephews, nieces . . .	<i>tsu</i>	<i>llga</i>	
Grandchildren . . .	<i>!gu!na</i>	<i>tün</i>	yes
Great-grandchildren . . .	<i>tsu</i>	<i>llga</i>	no

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The kin who are likened, by being of the same generation, to his parents, to his offspring, and to his siblings, are those to whom a !Kung feels the marriage regulations are particularly directed. Siblings of parents are 'like' parents, cousins are 'like' siblings, nephews and nieces are 'like' offspring. Marriage with all these is rigorously forbidden.

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Ego's marriage with great-grandparents, grandparents, grandchildren, and great-grandchildren is also forbidden but is not a concern. Age and consanguinity combine to push the very thought virtually out of mind. To the !Kung it seemed utterly ridiculous of me to inquire even about the collaterals in these generations. 'Those old people are already dead', said someone. 'It will be for my grandson to mind the rules when the young children grow up', said #Toma in effect. 'It is not my wish to marry a baby.'

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Category 2: affines

The second category of persons to whom the incest taboo is extended is composed of certain affines. Their affinal relationship is considered to be indissoluble once it is established, and ego's marriage with them is prohibited, even though the person through whom the affinal relationship with ego is brought about be dead or divorced. The thought of incestuous relations with at least some of these affines (especially parents of spouse and spouses of offspring) is as horrifying to a !Kung as if they were members of his nuclear family. We learned of no instances of the taboo being broken among them.

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The affines with whom marriage is forbidden, who correspond terminologically with ego's parents' generation, ego's own and that of his offspring, are listed in Fig. 3. Joking is allowed or not as it is with ego's kin in these generations.

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Parents of ego's SoWi and DaHu are terminologically of ego's generation and he may joke with them but he must not marry them, for that would make his So and SoWi or Da and DaHu stepbrother and stepsister to each other, which would be most awkward.

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